



ST. ANN'S COLLEGE FOR WOMEN

Run by The Society of St Anne

Affiliated to Acharya Nagarjuna University, Approved by AICTE

Recognised under Section 2(f) of the UGC Act 1956, New Delhi.

Accredited by NAAC with 'A' Grade in the first cycle

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EQUAL OPPORTUNITY CELL / SC-ST / MINORITY CELL

ANNUAL ACTIVITY REPORT

Academic Year 2025–2026

1. Introduction

The Equal Opportunity Cell (EOC) / SC-ST / Minority Cell of St. Ann's College for Women, Gorantla, Guntur, functions with the objective of promoting equality, inclusiveness, social justice and equal educational opportunities for all students, particularly those belonging to Scheduled Castes (SC), Scheduled Tribes (ST), Minority communities and other socially and economically disadvantaged sections.

During the academic year 2025–2026, the Cell undertook various awareness, facilitation, mentoring, scholarship-support and student empowerment activities in coordination with the IQAC, Student Counselling Cell, Mentor–Mentee System, Women Empowerment Cell, NSS, NCC, Grievance Redressal Cell and academic departments.

The activities were aimed at ensuring equitable access to education, Government welfare schemes, scholarships, academic support, career opportunities and institutional support services.

2. Objectives of the Cell

The major objectives of the Cell during the academic year were:

- To promote equal opportunity and an inclusive campus environment.
- To create awareness regarding constitutional rights, social justice and non-discrimination.
- To facilitate access to Government scholarships and welfare schemes.
- To provide guidance and support to SC/ST/Minority and other disadvantaged students.
- To identify students requiring academic, financial or personal support.
- To promote participation of disadvantaged students in academic, co-curricular and extracurricular activities.
- To create awareness regarding higher education, career opportunities and skill development.

- To strengthen student confidence, leadership and employability skills.
- To coordinate with various institutional support mechanisms for timely assistance.

3. ACTIVITIES CONDUCTED DURING THE ACADEMIC YEAR 2025–2026

Activity 1: Orientation and Awareness on Equal Opportunity and Student Support Services

Date: July 2025

Organised by: EOC / SC-ST / Minority Cell

An orientation and awareness programme was conducted for students to familiarize them with the functions of the Equal Opportunity Cell and other student support mechanisms available in the institution.

Students were informed about:

- Equal educational opportunities
- Non-discrimination and social inclusion
- Scholarship facilities
- Student counselling
- Mentor–Mentee support
- Grievance Redressal Mechanism
- Anti-Ragging measures
- Women Empowerment initiatives
- Career and skill-development opportunities

Outcome:

Students became aware of the institutional mechanisms available to support their academic and personal development.

Activity 2: Scholarship Awareness and Facilitation Programme

Date: August–November 2025

Organised by: EOC / SC-ST / Minority Cell

The Cell facilitated awareness and guidance regarding various **Government scholarship and welfare schemes** available to eligible students.

The programme included:

- Identification of eligible students
- Awareness regarding scholarship schemes
- Guidance on online applications
- Assistance regarding required documents
- Verification and follow-up of applications
- Guidance on resolving scholarship-related issues

The Cell coordinated with the concerned departments and authorities wherever necessary to facilitate eligible students.

Outcome:

Students were provided with timely information and assistance to access available financial support schemes.

Activity 3: Awareness Programme on Constitutional Values, Equality and Social Justice

Date: November 2025

Organised by: EOC / SC-ST / Minority Cell

An awareness programme was conducted on **constitutional values, equality, social justice and responsible citizenship**.

The programme highlighted:

- Equality and dignity
- Fundamental Rights and Duties
- Social justice
- Respect for diversity
- Non-discrimination
- Constitutional responsibilities
- Importance of social harmony

Outcome:

Students developed greater awareness of constitutional values and the importance of maintaining an inclusive and harmonious society.

Activity 4: Constitution Day Observance

Date: 26 November 2025

Organised in collaboration with: IQAC / Departments / Student Support Cells

The institution observed **Constitution Day** with activities aimed at creating awareness of the Constitution and its fundamental values.

Students were sensitized to the principles of **justice, liberty, equality and fraternity** and their relevance to educational institutions and responsible citizenship.

Outcome:

The programme strengthened awareness of constitutional values and democratic responsibilities among students.

Activity 5: Academic Mentoring and Student Support

Period: Throughout the Academic Year 2025–2026

The Cell worked in coordination with the **Mentor–Mentee System and concerned Departments** to identify students requiring additional academic and personal support.

Students were guided regarding:

- Regular attendance
- Academic performance
- Examination preparation
- Study habits
- Time management
- Participation in academic activities
- Seeking appropriate institutional support

Students requiring specialized assistance were referred to the appropriate support mechanism.

Outcome:

The activity contributed to improved academic monitoring, student confidence and timely intervention.

Activity 6: Career Guidance and Higher Education Awareness

Date: January 2026

Organised by: EOC / SC-ST / Minority Cell in collaboration with Training & Placement / Career Guidance initiatives

A career and higher education awareness programme was conducted for students, particularly those requiring additional guidance in planning their future careers.

The programme covered:

- Higher education opportunities
- Competitive examinations
- Employment opportunities
- Skill-development programmes
- Internships
- Placement opportunities
- Entrepreneurship
- Career planning

Outcome:

Students gained greater awareness of higher education and employment pathways and were encouraged to make informed career choices.

Activity 7: Capacity Building and Employability Skills Programme

Date: February 2026

Organised by: EOC / SC-ST / Minority Cell

A capacity-building programme was organized to strengthen students' confidence and employability.

The programme focused on:

- Communication skills
- Digital literacy
- Resume preparation

- Interview skills
- Group discussion
- Leadership
- Workplace etiquette
- Self-confidence

Outcome:

Students enhanced their communication, confidence and employability-related skills.

Activity 8: Awareness on Human Rights, Dignity and Non-Discrimination

Date: December 2025 / January 2026

Organised by: EOC / SC-ST / Minority Cell

A sensitization activity was conducted on **human dignity, equality, respect for diversity and prevention of discrimination**.

Students were encouraged to:

- Respect individual dignity
- Avoid discriminatory practices
- Promote social harmony
- Respect diversity
- Support an inclusive campus environment

Outcome:

The programme promoted a culture of mutual respect, tolerance and inclusion among students.

Activity 9: Women's Empowerment and Leadership Development

Date: March 2026

Organised in collaboration with: Women Empowerment Cell

As a women's institution, special emphasis was placed on the empowerment and leadership development of students belonging to disadvantaged communities.

The programme focused on:

- Self-confidence
- Leadership
- Decision-making
- Career planning
- Financial awareness
- Digital empowerment
- Entrepreneurship
- Personal development

Outcome:

Students were encouraged to develop leadership qualities, self-confidence and greater awareness of educational and career opportunities.

Activity 10: Student Participation and Inclusion in Institutional Activities

Period: Throughout the Academic Year 2025–2026

The Cell encouraged students from SC/ST/Minority and other disadvantaged backgrounds to actively participate in:

- Academic programmes
- Seminars and workshops
- Cultural activities
- Sports
- NSS and NCC activities
- Extension and outreach programmes
- Skill-development programmes
- Competitions
- Career and placement activities

Outcome:

The initiative promoted equal participation and provided students with opportunities for holistic development.

4. Student Support and Facilitation

Throughout the academic year, the Cell provided guidance and facilitated support in areas including:

- Government scholarships
- Academic mentoring
- Student counselling
- Career guidance
- Skill development
- Higher education opportunities
- Grievance support
- Access to institutional facilities
- Participation in co-curricular and extracurricular activities

Students requiring specialized assistance were guided to the appropriate institutional committee or support service.

5. Coordination with Institutional Support Cells

The EOC / SC-ST / Minority Cell worked in coordination with various institutional bodies, including:

- IQAC
- Student Counselling Cell
- Mentor–Mentee System
- Women Empowerment Cell
- Grievance Redressal Cell
- Anti-Ragging Committee
- NSS
- NCC
- Training & Placement Cell

- Career Guidance initiatives
- Academic Departments

This collaborative approach ensured that student support was provided in an integrated and timely manner.

6. Major Outcomes of the Year

The activities of the Cell during 2025–2026 resulted in:

1. Increased awareness of equal educational opportunities.
2. Improved awareness of Government scholarships and welfare schemes.
3. Greater understanding of constitutional values and social justice.
4. Enhanced awareness of non-discrimination and social inclusion.
5. Improved academic mentoring and student support.
6. Increased awareness of career and higher education opportunities.
7. Improved communication, confidence and employability skills.
8. Encouragement of participation in institutional and extracurricular activities.
9. Strengthened coordination among student-support mechanisms.
10. Promotion of an inclusive, respectful and student-friendly campus environment.

7. NAAC-Oriented Documentation Maintained

For quality assurance and institutional documentation, the Cell maintained relevant records such as:

- Constitution / Reconstitution of the Cell
- Annual Action Plan
- Meeting Minutes
- Notices and Circulars
- Programme Reports
- Student Attendance
- Photographic Evidence
- Resource Person Details

- Scholarship Facilitation Records
- Student Support Records
- Feedback, wherever applicable
- Outcome / Impact Statements
- Action Taken Reports
- Annual Activity Report

8. Conclusion

The EOC / SC-ST / Minority Cell of St. Ann's College for Women continued its efforts during the academic year 2025–2026 to promote equity, inclusion, social justice and equal opportunities for students.

Through awareness programmes, scholarship facilitation, mentoring, career guidance, capacity-building activities and coordination with institutional support mechanisms, the Cell contributed to the holistic development and educational empowerment of students.

The Cell remains committed to strengthening an inclusive, equitable, supportive and discrimination-free educational environment in accordance with the vision and values of the institution.

Submitted to:

The Principal

St. Ann's College for Women
Gorantla, Guntur

Prepared by:

Coordinator

Equal Opportunity Cell / SC-ST / Minority Cell

Academic Year:

2025–2026